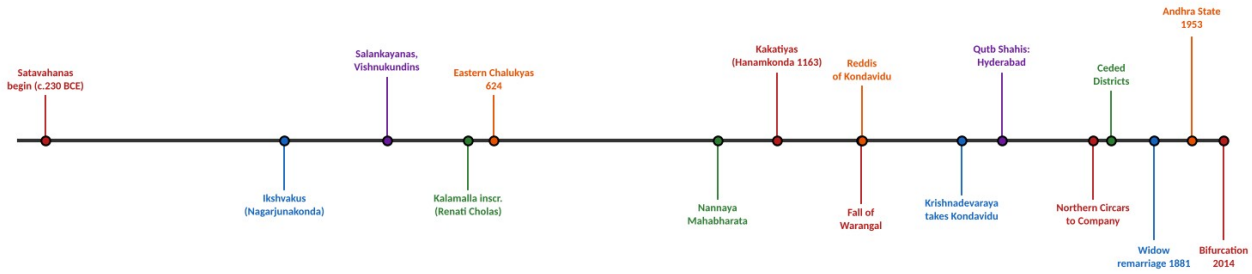
APPSC GROUP 1 / GROUP 2 — HISTORY

Volume 4: History and Culture of Andhra Pradesh — explained from the basics

Ancient · Early medieval · Kakatiyas, Reddis, Gajapatis · Vijayanagara and Telugu literature · Qutb Shahis and Vemana · Europeans and Company rule · Social reform · Nationalist movement · Andhra State, Andhra Pradesh and the 2014 bifurcation

How to use this volume:
1. Colours: **Blue** = simple explanation · **Orange** = Andhra Pradesh link (all regions) · **Red** = exam traps · **Green** = 2-minute revision · **Purple** = self-test.
2. **Who's who tables** give each person's one-line hook. There are no drawn portraits, because the people shown would only be guesses; use the hook line and the maps to remember.
3. Syllabus: Group 1 Mains Paper II Part B items 6–10 (Ancient, Medieval, Modern, Nationalist Movement, Bifurcation) and Group 2 History and Culture of AP. Volumes 1–2 give the India background; this volume is **Andhra only**.
4. Plan: 9 chapters in 9 days; revise green boxes on day 3 and day 10; then History Mock Test 4.
5. Dates and spellings of old names differ between books. Where scholars disagree the book says 'c.' (about). Learn the order of events and the famous names first.

Andhra history on one page (timeline)



Syllabus map

Syllabus item	Chapters
6 Ancient: Satavahanas, Ikshvakus, Salankayanas, Pallavas, Vishnukundins; society, economy, religion, Telugu, literature, art, Jainism and Buddhism. **Eastern Chalukyas, Rashtrakutas, Renati Cholas** and others	Ch 1–2
7 Medieval: social-cultural conditions 1000–1565; Telugu language and literature (Kavitraya, Ashtadiggajas); art and architecture under Kakatiyas, Reddis, Gajapatis, Vijayanagara; monuments; **Qutb Shahis**; Vemana and regional literature	Ch 3–5
8 Modern: Europeans, Company rule, missionaries, awakening, C.P. Brown, Munro, Mackenzie, zamindari, polegari, native states; reformers, library movement, newspapers, folk and tribal culture, women	Ch 6–7
9 Nationalist Movement: Andhra leaders, Justice Party, literature, Andhra Mahasabhas, Andhra movement, Potti Sriramulu, Andhra State 1953, Andhra Pradesh 1956, 1956–2014, bifurcation. **10 Bifurcation:** impact, capital, employees, river water, AP Reorganisation Act 2014	Ch 8–9

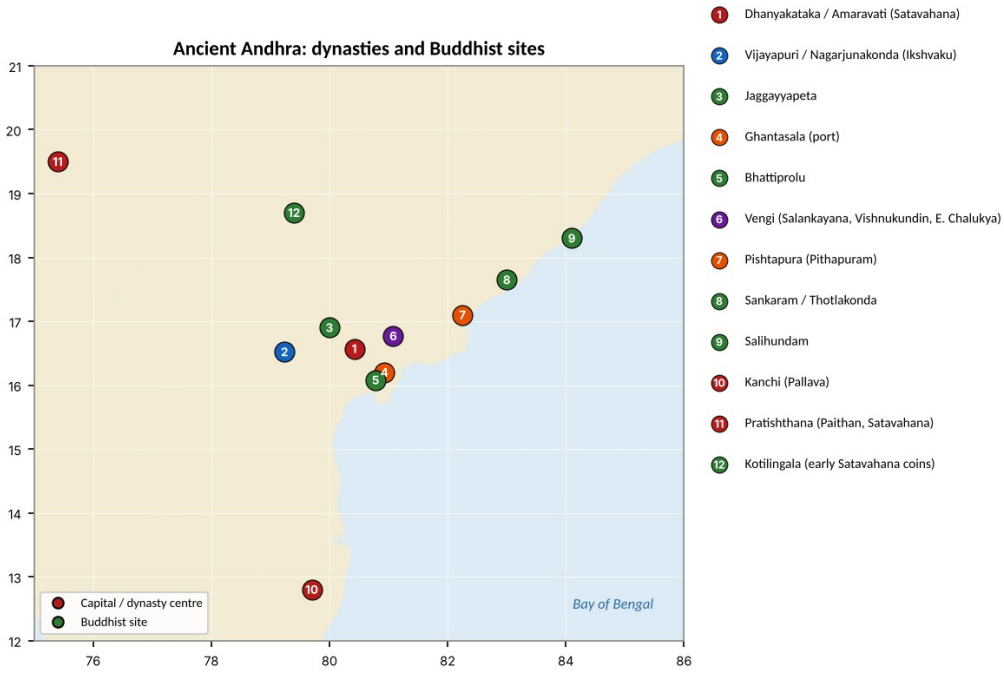
CHAPTER 1 — Ancient Andhra: From the Andhras to the Vishnukundins

c. 600 BCE – 624 CE

IN SIMPLE WORDS (what / how / why)

Why 'Andhra'? The word first appears for a **people**: the **Aitareya Brahmana** lists the Andhras among peoples living beyond the Aryan fold; **Megasthenes** (via Pliny) says the Andhras were strong, with about **30 walled towns, 1 lakh infantry, 2,000 cavalry and 1,000 elephants**. **Ashoka's Rock Edict XIII** names them among his frontier peoples.
Before the kings: Megalithic burials, **Asmaka (Assaka) mahajanapada** on the Godavari (capital Potana/Podana, near Bodhan), Ashoka's edicts at **Yerragudi and Rajula Mandagiri (Kurnool)**. The first great Andhra empire was that of the **Satavahanas**.

Map: ancient Andhra



Satavahanas (c. 230 BCE – 220 CE)

Ruler / topic	Key points
Simuka	Founder (Puranic date c. 230 BCE). Capital **Pratishthana (Paithan, Godavari)**; later **Dhanyakataka (Amaravati)** was the eastern capital
Satakarni I	Performed **Ashvamedha and Rajasuya**; wife **Naganika** issued the **Nanaghat inscription**; expanded to Malwa and Andhra
Hala	Compiled **Gathasaptashati** (Gahasattasai) — 700 Prakrit verses on everyday life
Gautamiputra Satakarni (c. 106–130 CE)	Greatest Satavahana. Defeated the **Shaka king Nahapana** (re-struck his coins); called **'destroyer of Shakas, Yavanas and Pahlavas'**. **Nasik inscription** by his mother **Gautami Balashri** praises him
Vasishthiputra Pulumavi	Extended the Amaravati stupa; ruled the south-east (Andhra)
Yajna Sri Satakarni	Last great ruler; **ship coins** show overseas trade; dynasty broke up soon after
Administration	Kingdom divided into **aharas** (districts); officials: **amatyas, mahasenapati, gaulmika** (head of a military/forest post); feudatories **Maharathis, Mahabhojas**; royal names were **matronymics** (Gautamiputra, Vasishthiputra)
Economy and society	Rich trade with Rome via ports like **Ghantasala (Kantakasela), Kodur, Machilipatnam**; Roman coins found in Andhra; **guilds (nigamas)** gave donations; lead, potin, silver and copper coins; four varnas but mixed marriages; women were donors and sometimes property holders
Religion, language, art	Brahmanism (Vedic sacrifices) and **Buddhism**; official language **Prakrit** (Brahmi script) with Sanskrit; Telugu personal and place names appear in the records. **Amaravati** (Mahachaitya, white limestone reliefs, 'Andhra school'), **Jaggayyapeta, Ghantasala, Bhattiprolu**; **Karle chaitya** (Maharashtra)

Ikshvakus, Salankayanas, Pallavas and Vishnukundins

Dynasty	Capital / period	Key points
Ikshvakus	**Vijayapuri (Nagarjunakonda)**; c. 225–325 CE	Founder **Vasishthiputra Chamtamula (Santamula I)** performed Ashvamedha and Vajapeya; **Virapurushadatta**, **Ehuvula Chamtamula**, **Rudrapurushadatta**. Royal **women** (Chamtisiri, Adavi Santisiri) built Buddhist viharas; **Nagarjunakonda** was a major Buddhist centre (Mahachaitya, apsidal temples, monasteries). Linked with **Acharya Nagarjuna (Madhyamika)**. Site excavated before the **Nagarjuna Sagar** dam submerged it; relics shifted to the island museum
Salankayanas	**Vengi** (Pedavegi, near Eluru); c. 300–440	**Hastivarman** met Samudragupta (Allahabad pillar); devotees of **Chitraratha Swami (Sun/Vishnu)**; Brahmanical
Pallavas in Andhra	Early Pallavas ruled coastal and southern Andhra from **Kanchi**	**Sivaskandavarman**: **Mayidavolu plates (Guntur)** and **Hirahadagalli plates (Bellary)** in Prakrit
Vishnukundins	**Denduluru**, later **Indrapalanagara / Amaravati area**; c. 420–624	**Madhavavarman II (Janashraya)** performed **eleven Ashvamedhas**; Govindavarman built Buddhist monasteries; **Undavalli and Mogalrajapuram rock-cut caves** (Vijayawada area). Ended when **Pulakeshin II** conquered the coast and gave it to his brother **Kubja Vishnuvardhana** (c. 624) — start of the Eastern Chalukyas
Others	Brihatphalayanas (Kondamudi), Anandagotrikas (Guntur), Matharas (Kalinga)	Small dynasties between the Ikshvakus and the Chalukyas

Samudragupta's southern campaign (c. 350 CE): the Allahabad pillar names Andhra kings defeated and re-instated: **Hastivarman of Vengi**, **Vishnugopa of Kanchi**, **Ugrasena of Palakka (Nellore)**, **Kubera of Devarashtra**, **Mantaraja of Kurala**, **Nilaraja of Avamukta**, **Svamidatta of Pishtapura (Pithapuram)** and **Damana of Erandapalla** — a favourite list.

Buddhism, Jainism and Telugu in ancient Andhra

• **Buddhism: Amaravati** (Mahachaitya), **Nagarjunakonda**, **Bhattiprolu** (relic casket with an early Brahmi variant script, 3rd–2nd c. BCE), **Jaggayyapeta, Ghantasala, Salihundam, Thotlakonda, Bavikonda, Sankaram**; sects **Purvashaila and Aparashaila (Mahasanghika branches)**; **Nagarjuna** (Madhyamika philosophy) and later **Dinnaga** (logic) are associated with Andhra. • **Jainism:** spread by monks from the north; **Kolanupaka** (Jain centre), **Penugonda and Ramatirtham** have Jain remains; later Jainism lost to Shaivism and Vaishnavism. • **Telugu:** a Dravidian language; the word 'Telugu' may derive from **Trilinga/Tenugu**. Early Telugu words occur in Satavahana and Ikshvaku records; the **Kalamalla inscription (c. 575 CE, Kadapa) of the Renati Chola Erikal Muduraju Dhananjaya** is the earliest full Telugu inscription. The script grew from **Brahmi** through the **Telugu-Kannada (Kadamba–Chalukya) script** by about the 11th century.

Who's who

Person	Known for	Person	Known for
Simuka	Founder of the Satavahanas	**Gautamiputra Satakarni**	Beat Nahapana; Nasik inscription
Gautami Balashri	Mother who wrote the Nasik prashasti	**Yajna Sri Satakarni**	Ship coins; last great Satavahana
Chamtamula (Santamula I)	Ikshvaku founder; Ashvamedha	**Chamtisiri**	Ikshvaku princess; Buddhist donor
Madhavavarman II	Vishnukundin; eleven Ashvamedhas	**Hastivarman**	Salankayana of Vengi; Samudragupta's foe

ANDHRA PRADESH LINK

Andhra links by region: Rayalaseema – Ashokan edicts at Yerragudi and Rajula Mandagiri, Billa Surgam caves, Kalamalla inscription · **Coastal Andhra** – Amaravati (Dhanyakataka), Ghantasala, Chebrolu, Bhattiprolu stupa · **North Andhra** – Salihundam, Thotlakonda, Bavikonda, Sisupalgarh (Kalinga) · **Telangana** – Kotilingala, Kondapur, Peddabankur; Nagarjunakonda and Srisailam are linked to Nagarjuna.

EXAM TRAPS

Satavahana capital: Pratishthana (Paithan) first; **Amaravati/Dhanyakataka** later. **Nanaghat inscription** = Naganika. **Nasik inscription** = Gautami Balashri.
Ikshvakus = Nagarjunakonda; **Salankayanas** = Vengi; **Vishnukundins** = 11 Ashvamedhas, Undavalli caves.
Earliest **Telugu inscription** = Kalamalla (575 CE, Renati Cholas), not an Eastern Chalukya record.

2-MINUTE REVISION

Andhras (Aitareya, Megasthenes, Ashoka) → Satavahanas (Simuka, Gautamiputra, Hala, ship coins; Amaravati) → Ikshvakus (Nagarjunakonda; women donors) → Salankayanas (Vengi) → Vishnukundins (11 Ashvamedhas; Undavalli) → Chalukyas 624.

CHECK YOURSELF

Q. Who wrote the Gathasaptashati? **Hala.** Q. Capital of the Ikshvakus? **Vijayapuri (Nagarjunakonda).** Q. Earliest Telugu inscription? **Kalamalla (c. 575).**